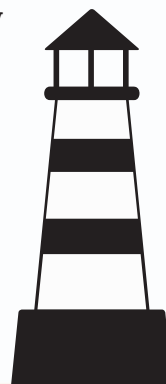


COAST GUARDSMAN

JOB DESCRIPTION

Coast Guardsmen undertake search-and-rescue missions in coastal areas, providing emergency support to ships and people in difficulty at sea. They also monitor shipping movements, recommend safety procedures, and are responsible for checking and maintaining safety equipment, as well as reporting any pollution incidents and illegal shipping activities in a specific area.



SALARY

Seaman recruit ★★★★★

Chief Master Petty Officer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Smallest branch of the military • Approximately 42,000 coast guardsmen on active duty

CAREER PATHS

Initial training to be a US Coast Guardsman begins with Basic Training. Around the fourth week of training, you can request a location for your first assignment and the type of unit you wish to serve. You can also request to serve ashore or afloat.

HIGH SCHOOL GRADUATE

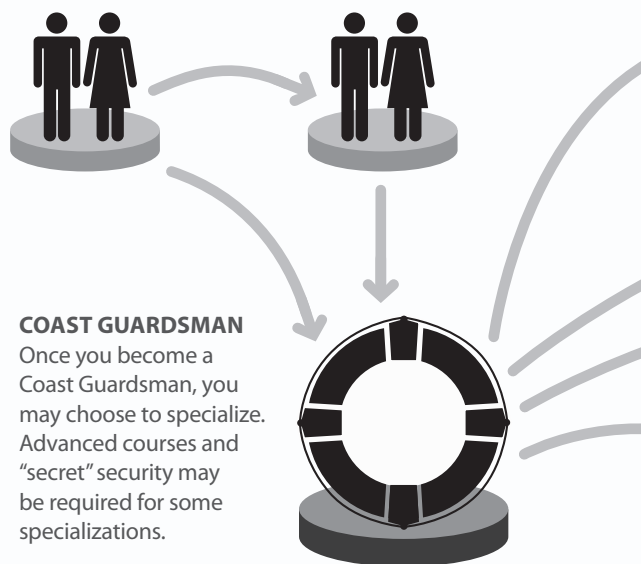
You must have a high school diploma or a GED with 15 or more college credits to enlist in the US Coast Guard.

COLLEGE GRADUATE

A bachelor's degree is required for those who wish to apply to Officer Candidate School. Some specialties may require a master's degree.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **SHIP'S CAPTAIN** *see pp. 220–221*
- ▶ **NAVY SAILOR** *see pp. 234–235*
- ▶ **CUSTOMS OFFICER** Monitors and prevents illegal trade across international borders.
- ▶ **FISHING VESSEL SKIPPER** Takes overall responsibility for a commercial fishing boat, planning routes, ensuring that the crew are safe, and arranging sale of the catch once in port.



COAST GUARDSMAN

Once you become a Coast Guardsman, you may choose to specialize. Advanced courses and "secret" security may be required for some specializations.